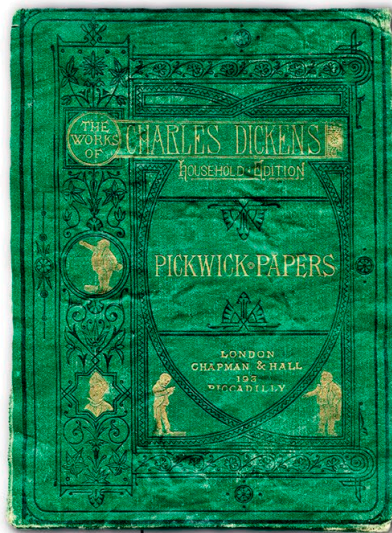


1836

CHARLES DICKENS PUBLISHES HIS FIRST NOVEL

Already a successful writer, Dickens published his first novel *Pickwick Papers* as a serial over 20 months. The book was a huge success that established Dickens' reputation as one of Britain's greatest writers and made him internationally famous.

▷ The *Pickwick Papers*, early cover

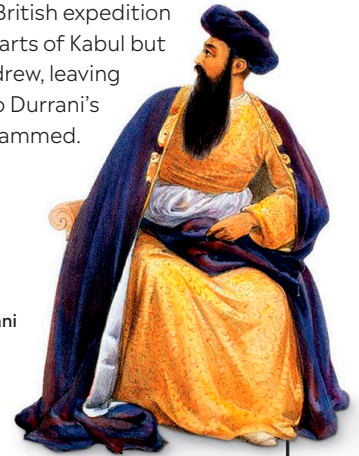


1839-42

FIRST ANGLO-AFGHAN WAR

In the first major conflict of the Great Game – Britain and Russia's struggle for influence in Central Asia – Britain intervened in Afghanistan, installing Shah Shujah Durrani as ruler. The British army was annihilated during its retreat from Kabul in 1842.

A second British expedition destroyed parts of Kabul but quickly withdrew, leaving Afghanistan to Durrani's rival, Dost Mohammed.



▷ Shah Shujah Durrani

1835

1835 The Black War between British colonists and Aboriginal Australians in Tasmania ends

1835 Dutch settlers leave the British Cape Colony, moving further north into Southern Africa on the Great Trek



◁ Alamo defenders, memorial frieze

1837 Queen Victoria begins her 63-year reign of the UK

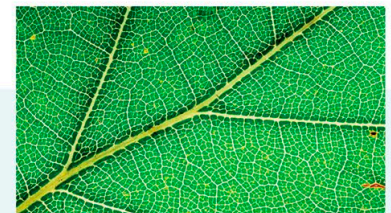
1836

TEXAS REVOLUTION ENDS

Fighting between the Republic of Mexico and American and Hispanic colonists in Texas broke out in October 1835. After the Mexicans killed the Texan defenders of the Alamo Mission in March, the Texan army defeated Mexican forces at the Battle of San Jacinto, securing independence for the Republic of Texas.

1838-1953 ADVANCES IN BIOLOGY

In the 19th century, several key discoveries in cell biology and heredity helped unlock the secrets of life, paving the way for the decoding of DNA in the 20th century.



1838 Cell theory is developed as German biologists Matthias Schleiden and Theodor Schwann postulate that the cell is the basic unit of life and all living organisms are composed of cells.